O*NET OnLine

Computer User Support Specialists

15-1232.00

Updated 2026

Provide technical assistance to computer users. Answer questions or resolve computer problems for clients in person, via telephone, or electronically. May provide assistance concerning the use of computer hardware and software, including printing, installation, word processing, electronic mail, and operating systems.

Sample of reported job titles: Computer Support Specialist, Computer Tech (Computer Technician), Desktop Support Technician (Desktop Support Tech), Help Desk Analyst, Help Desk Tech (Help Desk Technician), IS Tech (Information Systems Technician), IT Specialist (Information Technology Specialist), IT Support Specialist (Information Technology Support Specialist), IT Tech (Information Technology Technician), Technical Support Specialist

Occupation-Specific Information

Tasks

5 of 16 displayed

- Oversee the daily performance of computer systems.
- Set up equipment for employee use, performing or ensuring proper installation of cables, operating systems, or appropriate software.
- Read technical manuals, confer with users, or conduct computer diagnostics to investigate and resolve problems or to provide technical assistance and support.
- Answer user inquiries regarding computer software or hardware operation to resolve problems.
- Install and perform minor repairs to hardware, software, or peripheral equipment, following design or installation specifications.

Occupational Requirements

Work Activities

5 of 25 displayed

- **Working with Computers** — Using computers and computer systems (including hardware and software) to program, write software, set up functions, enter data, or process information.
- **Getting Information** — Observing, receiving, and otherwise obtaining information from all relevant sources.
- **Communicating with Supervisors, Peers, or Subordinates** — Providing information to supervisors, co-workers, and subordinates by telephone, in written form, e-mail, or in person.
- **Making Decisions and Solving Problems** — Analyzing information and evaluating results to choose the best solution and solve problems.
- **Updating and Using Relevant Knowledge** — Keeping up-to-date technically and applying new knowledge to your job.

Detailed Work Activities

5 of 22 displayed

- Monitor computer system performance to ensure proper operation.
- Collaborate with others to resolve information technology issues.
- Install computer hardware.
- Read documents to gather technical information.
- Resolve computer software problems.

Work Context

5 of 21 displayed

- **E-Mail** — 100% responded “Every day.”
- **Indoors, Environmentally Controlled** — 95% responded “Every day.”
- **Face-to-Face Discussions with Individuals and Within Teams** — 88% responded “Every day.”
- **Telephone Conversations**
- **Freedom to Make Decisions**

Experience Requirements

Job Zone

Title	Job Zone Three: Medium Preparation Needed
Education	Most occupations in this zone require training in vocational schools, related on-the-job experience, or an associate's degree.
Related Experience	Previous work-related skill, knowledge, or experience is required for these occupations. For example, an electrician must have completed three or four years of apprenticeship or several years of vocational training, and often must have passed a licensing exam, in order to perform the job.
Job Training	Employees in these occupations usually need one or two years of training involving both on-the-job experience and informal training with experienced

workers. A recognized apprenticeship program may be associated with these occupations.

Job Zone Examples These occupations usually involve using communication and organizational skills to coordinate, supervise, manage, or train others to accomplish goals. Examples include hydroelectric production managers, desktop publishers, electricians, agricultural technicians, barbers, court reporters and simultaneous captioners, and medical assistants.

SVP Range (6.0 to < 7.0)

Training & Credentials

State training Select a State Go

Local training ZIP Code Go

Certifications Find certifications nationwide

Apprenticeship Opportunities

5 of 9 displayed

Example apprenticeship titles for this occupation:

- Cloud Operations Specialist 1
- Cloud Operations Specialist 2
- Computer Support Specialist
- Computer Support Specialist-Desktop Support Tech
- Customer Service Tech Support

Specific title(s) listed above are vetted by industry and approved by the U.S. Department of Labor for use in a Registered Apprenticeship Program.

Start your career and build your skillset. Visit **Apprenticeship.gov** to learn about opportunities related to this occupation.

Worker Requirements

Software Skills

5 of 72 displayed

- **Data base management system software** — Apache Hive; Elasticsearch; MongoDB; Oracle PL/SQL

- **Data base user interface and query software** — Blackboard software; MySQL; ServiceNow; Transact-SQL
- **Development environment software** — Apache Kafka; Apache Maven; Eclipse IDE; Microsoft PowerShell
- **Operating system software** — Apple iOS; Google Android; Microsoft Windows Server; UNIX Shell
- **Web platform development software** — Django; Google Angular; Microsoft ASP.NET; Spring Framework

Hot Technologies are requirements most frequently included across all employer job postings.
See all 113 Hot Technologies for this occupation.

In Demand skills are frequently included in employer job postings for this occupation.
See all 12 In Demand skills for this occupation.

Essential Skills

5 of 8 displayed

- **Active Listening** — Giving full attention to what other people are saying, taking time to understand the points being made, asking questions as appropriate, and not interrupting at inappropriate times.
- **Reading Comprehension** — Understanding written sentences and paragraphs in work-related documents.
- **Speaking** — Talking to others to convey information effectively.
- **Critical Thinking** — Using logic and reasoning to identify the strengths and weaknesses of alternative solutions, conclusions, or approaches to problems.
- **Writing** — Communicating effectively in writing as appropriate for the needs of the audience.

Transferable Skills

5 of 9 displayed

- **Complex Problem Solving** — Identifying complex problems and reviewing related information to develop and evaluate options and implement solutions.
- **Judgment and Decision Making** — Considering the relative costs and benefits of potential actions to choose the most appropriate one.
- **Service Orientation** — Actively looking for ways to help people.
- **Social Perceptiveness** — Being aware of others' reactions and understanding why they react as they do.
- **Instructing** — Teaching others how to do something.

Knowledge

5 of 11 displayed

- **Computers and Electronics** — Knowledge of circuit boards, processors, chips, electronic equipment, and computer hardware and software, including applications and programming.

- **Customer and Personal Service** — Knowledge of principles and processes for providing customer and personal services. This includes customer needs assessment, meeting quality standards for services, and evaluation of customer satisfaction.
- **Telecommunications** — Knowledge of transmission, broadcasting, switching, control, and operation of telecommunications systems.
- **English Language** — Knowledge of the structure and content of the English language including the meaning and spelling of words, and rules of composition and grammar.
- **Education and Training** — Knowledge of principles and methods for curriculum and training design, teaching and instruction for individuals and groups, and the measurement of training effects.

Education

How much education does a new hire need to perform a job in this occupation? Respondents said:

- Bachelor's degree required for some jobs
- Post-secondary certificate required for some jobs
- Associate's degree or other 2-year degree required for some jobs

Worker Characteristics

Abilities

5 of 16 displayed

- **Oral Comprehension** — The ability to listen to and understand information and ideas presented through spoken words and sentences.
- **Oral Expression** — The ability to communicate information and ideas in speaking so others will understand.
- **Written Comprehension** — The ability to read and understand information and ideas presented in writing.
- **Near Vision** — The ability to see details at close range (within a few feet of the observer).
- **Written Expression** — The ability to communicate information and ideas in writing so others will understand.

Interests

All 3 displayed

Interest code: **CRI**

Want to discover your interests? Take the **O*NET Interest Profiler**.

- **Conventional** — Work involves following procedures and regulations to organize information or data, typically in a business setting. Conventional occupations are often associated with office work, accounting, mathematics/statistics, information technology, finance, or human resources.
  - **Information Technology** — Work involves designing, developing, testing, and maintaining computer software, hardware, networks, and systems.

- **Office Work** — Work involves clerical and administrative tasks for an organization such as answering phones, bookkeeping, updating records, scheduling appointments or meetings, and editing of documents and files.

- **Realistic** — Work involves designing, building, or repairing of equipment, materials, or structures, engaging in physical activity, or working outdoors. Realistic occupations are often associated with engineering, mechanics and electronics, construction, woodworking, transportation, machine operation, agriculture, animal services, physical or manual labor, athletics, or protective services.
  - **Mechanics/Electronics** — Work involves maintaining and repairing of machinery, such as automotive engines, electronic equipment, computers, and communication systems.
- **Investigative** — Work involves studying and researching non-living objects, living organisms, disease or other forms of impairment, or human behavior. Investigative occupations are often associated with physical, life, medical, or social sciences, and can be found in the fields of humanities, mathematics/statistics, information technology, or health care service.

Work Styles

All 2 displayed

- **Attention to Detail** — A tendency to be detail-oriented, organized, and thorough in completing work.
- **Dependability** — A tendency to be reliable, responsible, and consistent in meeting work-related obligations.

Workforce Characteristics

Wages & Employment Trends

Median wages (2025)	$29.74 hourly, $61,860 annual
State wages	Select a State Go
Local wages	ZIP Code Go
Employment (2025)	750,600 employees
Projected growth (2025-2035)	Decline (-1% or lower)
Projected job openings (2025-2035)	39,700
State trends	Select a State Go
Top industries (2025)	Professional, Scientific, and Technical Services Educational Services

Source: Bureau of Labor Statistics 2025 wage data and 2025-2035 employment projections. "Projected growth" represents the estimated change in total employment over the projections period (2025-2035). "Projected job openings" represent openings due to growth and replacement.

Job Openings on the Web

State job openings Select a State Go

Local job openings ZIP Code Go

More Information

Related Occupations

5 of 10 displayed

- 15-1231.00 Computer Network Support Specialists
- 15-1211.00 Computer Systems Analysts Bright Outlook
- 15-1299.08 Computer Systems Engineers/Architects
- 15-1244.00 Network and Computer Systems Administrators
- 15-1252.00 Software Developers

Professional Associations

Disclaimer: Sources are listed to provide additional information on related jobs, specialties, and/or industries. Links to non-DOL Internet sites are provided for your convenience and do not constitute an endorsement.

National Associations

5 of 7 displayed

- Association for Computing Machinery
- Association of Support Professionals
- Computing Research Association
- IEEE Computer Society
- Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers

Accreditation, Certification, & Unions

- CompTIA